

Tobias Treppmann

Product designer who ships full-loop — brief, design, prototype, in code

CONTACT

LOCATION

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PORTFOLIO

treppmann.design/for/taxfix-ai-first-builder-design

LINKEDIN

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EDUCATION

M.A. Leadership

Kairos University, South Dakota, USA
2022 – 2026

Theological Studies

Theologisches Seminar Rheinland
2003 – 2007

LANGUAGES

German · native

English · C2, fluent

ONGOING

Independent Consultant

Oratio&Co

2016 – Present · Remote

Collaborative leadership coaching; design-thinking and product-strategy consulting for non-profits, religious organisations, and mission-driven ventures.

PROFILE

I've been designing software for fifteen years, working brief to shipped code. The past year at Bibel TV is the most interesting one — AI tools that actually ship: fundraising, support copilot, design infrastructure. Before that, design leadership at Ninox, ChurchDesk, Datameer, and Hypoport. Berlin-based, German native.

EXPERIENCE

Head of Product Design

2025 – Present

Bibel TV (B2C media platform across mobile, web, and connected TV) · Hamburg (2 days/week) + Berlin (Remote), Germany

- AI Fundraising Ecosystem (solo, end-to-end) — analysed past letter performance to identify seasonality and style patterns separating over- from under-performers; encoded findings into a Claude Project with a multi-turn clarifying-question loop; built an internal web prototype for the fundraising team; shipped a Claude skill producing follow-up content across in-app notifications, web banners, and video scripts
- Customer-Support Copilot Skill (live in production) — MS Copilot skill drafting responses to viewer letters against the CS handbook as context; defined "good draft" with the CS team before prompt-tuning; kept human send-decision absolute; made escalation a first-class output for sensitive/crisis messages; adopted across the full team through self-testing week + 1:1 sessions
- Agentic Engineering as Design Practice — prototyped the new Bibel TV experience for web then Android using Claude Code on real APIs; engineering copies component structures, API calls, and navigation patterns into production; iteration collapsed from days to hours
- Design System as API — DTCG-standard token repository, three-tier hierarchy (global → semantic → component); Style Dictionary build with multi-platform sync (Android live, Figma live via plugin, iOS/web ready); one commit propagates everywhere; supports server-driven UI
- Mobile App Redesign + Experimentation — leading iOS/Android/web/connected TV redesign for engagement and retention; partnering with engineering on experimentation framework and A/B testing infrastructure; running "Designing with and for AI" workshop series

Head of Platform and Design

2024 – 2025

ChurchDesk GmbH (European church-management SaaS across DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · Copenhagen, Denmark · Remote from Berlin

- Funeral-Booking System (dual PM + Design) — reframed scope from "feature" into a platform capability; owned build-vs-buy and standalone-vs-integrated decisions; designed multi-stakeholder coordination logic from first principles (availability rules, buffer/lead-time, progressive disclosure); 70% coordination-time reduction (days → hours), 90% booking acceptance rate, 20+ cemeteries; became a core platform feature beyond the initial region
- AI & Accessibility in Production — shipped AI alt-text generation for EU accessibility compliance; automated accessibility processes across customer-facing content under GDPR + Protestant/Catholic church data-protection law across six countries (DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH)
- CS-Workflow Platform Modules — delivered shared inbox with multi-user team-inbox routing, case-management ticket system, and booking system as core platform capabilities for client churches
- Team & Customer — managed 1 direct report (designer); main customer-facing contact for the launch parish with direct customer contact throughout

Head of Product Design

2023 – 2024

Ninox Software GmbH (AI-powered no-code business platform, DACH / UK / US) · Berlin, Germany

- Prompt-to-Database AI Onboarding (with CEO & co-founder) — designed in founder-led stealth; split-screen direct manipulation where AI-generated schema renders into the real data-model editor, not a chat preview; rejected chat-only default from first principles; user-agency principle: "show output, allow users to edit"; adopted as basis for the public AI beta (Feb 2026)
- Design as Strategic Function — established design co-equal with product and engineering; SLT member; guided platform evolution from low-code ERP to AI-powered no-code for SME workflows (law firms, contractors, inspectors)
- Team Leadership & Coaching — managed 5 direct reports incl. a design lead; coached the design lead through a difficult engineering-lead partnership by reframing "what's wrong with that person" as "what's wrong with our system"; redesigned rituals to include a sidelined engineer who became a top contributor; made performance calls both directions (hired 2, let go 2); established shared design-system governance across 4 designers + engineering

Product & UX Strategist

2021 – 2022

Hypoport Hub SE (Hypoport Group shared service center; service-to-product transformation) · Berlin / Lübeck, Germany · Remote

- Service-to-Product Transformation — partnered with the executive team to productise internal services at the shared service center; transformed individualised, case-by-case support into a standardised, scalable service catalog
- ITSM & Internal Tooling — worked with IT on service-desk implementation and internal operations tooling for the wider Hypoport Group
- Methodology Transfer & Executive Influence — applied UX, Agile, and product methodologies to a service organisation; designed and delivered design-thinking training for executive leadership and service teams; primary stakeholder contact presenting to executives

Director of Design

2016 – 2021

Datameer GmbH (Collaborative big-data analytics platform for top US / CA / UK banks & insurers) · Germany & NYC, USA · cross-Atlantic

- Cross-Atlantic Design Leadership (5 years, DE + NYC) — led the design team across a 6-hour time-zone gap; established time-boxed strategic-initiatives methodology (persona development, lighthouse projects) to balance strategic and tactical work; sustained consistency through written decisions and async rituals
- Platform Redesign for Regulated Finance — redesigned the collaborative data-analytics platform for data engineers, analysts, and business users at top US / CA / UK banks and insurers; pioneered iterative usertesting.com screening to reach hard-to-reach regulated personas; built the design system from scratch
- UX Maturity Elevation — elevated design from execution-focused function to strategic business partner; secured executive support for user research in the regulated-industry context; measurably increased UX maturity

EARLIER CAREER PROGRESSION

UX Strategy Lead · *Spreadshirt* · 2014 – 2016 · Leipzig

UX Manager · *HairDirect* · 2013 – 2014 · Lancaster, PA, USA

UX Designer · *andCulture* · 2012 – 2013 · Harrisburg, PA, USA

Web Designer & Front-End Developer · *HOPE International* · 2009 – 2012 · Lancaster, PA, USA

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2008 – 2009 · Remote

Freelance Web Designer · 2003 – 2008 · Remote

Web Designer · *Bajaa.com* · 2000 – 2003 · Remote

E-Commerce Assistant · *Westfalia Werkzeugcompany* · 1999 · Hagen, Germany

SKILLS

AI-Era Product Design & Agentic Engineering

Shipping AI products in production (Copilot skill, AI fundraising ecosystem) · Prompt-to-database interaction patterns · "Show output, let users edit" user-agency principle · Agentic engineering with Claude Code on real APIs · AI in regulated environments (GDPR, church data-protection law)

Full-Loop Craft

Brief → design → prototype → code · Prototype in real code (Swift, Kotlin, real APIs) · First-principles interaction design · Content design as prompt engineering · User research when the job requires

Design Systems & Cross-Platform Engineering

Design-system-as-API · DTCG standard format · Three-tier token hierarchies · Multi-platform sync (Figma / iOS / Android / Web) · Style Dictionary · Tokens Studio · OKLCH · Server-driven UI · SwiftUI · React handoff

Metrics, Experimentation & Research

Metric ownership (70% coordination-time reduction, 90% booking acceptance) · A/B testing infrastructure · Research as strategic input · Continuous research in product cycles · UX psychology (Locus of Control, Cognitive Load, Progressive Disclosure)

Distributed / Multi-Market Delivery

Cross-timezone delivery (Germany / NYC) · Multi-country product (DE / DK / UK / SE / NO / CH) · German native + English C2 · Written-first decision artifacts · Time-boxed strategic initiatives